

Robin Riley

Open Source Strategist, Nonprofit Executive, and
Community Organizer

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Robin Riley is a nonprofit executive and community organizer based in Petaluma, California, specializing in open source, civics, and web technology.

She works at the intersection of social and technical systems, and has a passion for building up people, programs, partnerships, and organizations. Robin has a deep track record in complex community relations and her background includes organizational development, governance, business operations, events, communications, marketing, web development, as well as nonprofit, campaign, program, and people management. She uses these skills and her network to help organizations and communities mature, put their best foot forward, and collaborate with each other.

Robin often works independently through her consultancy, Open Chapters, and recently completed a 2-year full-time contract as Managing Director of The Matrix.org Foundation. She has previously worked for Tidelift, Google, and O'Reilly Media, among others.

Affiliations

- Partner in **Open Chapters**, her consultancy through which she does independent work.
- Board Director for **Petaluma Pride**, in which she serves as a mentor to the rest of the leadership team.
- Co-organizer of **North Bay Python**, an event she helps run that focuses on the human context of tech.
- Commissioner for **Sonoma County Library**, where she provides oversight and guidance.
- Chapter Leader at **ACLU NorCal, Sonoma County**, through which she advances civil liberties.

Experience

Managing Director of The Matrix.org Foundation, Sept. 2023 to Nov. 2025

- Established open governance, bringing together stakeholders from across the ecosystem, to guide the Foundation, solve ecosystem-wide challenges, and increase volunteer capacity.
- Massively expanded the membership program and extended the financial runway long enough to land new major institutional donors.
- Managed communications across numerous channels, leveraging growing antipathy toward Big Tech and their extractive practices to position Matrix for rapid growth in adoption.

Board Leadership of Petaluma Pride, Jan. 2022 to Present

Assistant Secretary and Assistant Treasurer from March 2026 to Present

- Develop other board members into more capable leaders, emphasizing succession planning.
- Formalize structures and processes to increase agility and expand volunteer capacity.
- Establish foundational policies and procedures.

Secretary and Treasurer from September 2024 to March 2026

- Guided the board through recruitment and re-organization, providing mentorship to new leadership.

- Consolidated organizational resources to build institutional knowledge and ease collaboration.
- Created and managed budgets, accounts receivable, accounts payable, and annual filings.

Vice President from April 2024 to September 2024

- Completed the transition from being a fiscally sponsored project to become a fully independent and self-sustaining nonprofit, from by-law drafting to federal, state, and local filings.
- Facilitated the organization's first annual board retreat including vision and strategy setting sessions.

Operations Lead from January 2022 to April 2024

- Deepened relationships with local organizations representing other marginalized groups.
- Managed infrastructure, budget, inventory, and assets to support our annual festival.
- Drove greater team discipline in meeting and communications practices.

Upstream Relations at Tidelift, Jan. 2021 to Mar. 2023

Senior Principal Foundations Advocate from October 2022 to March 2023

- Built and managed relationships with open source foundations to support member projects, maintainers, and design novel programs to create healthier, more resilient open source communities.
- Advocated for open source foundations in a changing industry, funding, and regulatory environment.

Senior Ecosystem Strategy Lead from January 2022 to October 2022

- Built a team with a program management and developer relations practice that prioritized operational excellence, organization-wide enablement, and an improved experience for upstream partners.
- Eliminated process and documentation debt, establishing institutional knowledge and cross-departmental partnerships to support consistent operations.

Ecosystem Strategy Lead from January 2021 to January 2022

- Chaired the Upstream conference, creating the vision and recruiting high profile speakers in partnership with marketing, while co-founded Maintainer Month in collaboration with colleagues at GitHub.
- Recruited maintainers to participate in pilot programs in support of product and engineering work toward product-market fit and an improved user experience.
- Assessed process, data, and staffing to identify gaps and illuminate a path to operational excellence.

Campaign Manager for Blake Hooper, Jan. 2021 to Nov. 2024

Blake Hooper for Council 2024 from January 2024 to November 2024

- Managed a team of about 6 volunteers and 3 paid staffers, to reach more than 10,000 people in Petaluma's first ever City Council District 5 election.
- Established and managed the public-facing media and internal infrastructure for the campaign.
- Organized well attended and well appointed campaign kick-off and election night events.

Blake Hooper for Supervisor 2022 from January 2021 to June 2022

- Built a core team of 12 dedicated volunteers, and 3 paid staffers, that engaged hundreds more to reach the more than 100,000 people in Sonoma County District 2.
- Established infrastructure, reporting lines, meeting practices, and a team culture that's been described by many volunteers as the most humane and nontoxic political organization they ever worked with.
- Drove design and production processes, as well as press relations, online marketing, and advertising.
- Managed budget priorities and ended with just enough in reserve to maintain basic infrastructure.

Senior Open Source Strategist at Salesforce, Apr. 2019 to Dec. 2020

- Collaborated across legal, security, and marketing departments to streamline compliance review for upstream open source contributions, driving a 25% increase in donations to community projects.
- Created an open source documentation hub, braiding together resources and leadership from security and legal teams, to facilitate more open source engagement and leadership.
- Started Salesforce's FOSS Fund, engaging staff to direct regular donations to open source projects and creating greater awareness of Salesforce's dependence on third-party community-developed software.

Open Source Outreach Program Manager at Google, Apr. 2016 to Apr. 2019

- Brought together communications managers, marketers, and open source leadership spanning strategy, outreach, and compliance to harmonize open source communications across Alphabet.
- Built the communications program, managed 7 social channels and served as editor-in-chief publishing 80 blog posts from 70 authors per year, doubling audience size and read time.
- Designed, built, and maintained tools and infrastructure to support global programs like Google Summer of Code, increasing speed and accuracy while providing a better experience for participants.

Board Leadership for Open Source Initiative, Mar. 2016 to Feb. 2022

Chairperson from September 2021 to February 2022

- Landed the many years project, across multiple classes of board members, to transform OSI from a working board to a supervisory board and empower staff to carry out the mission of the organization.
- Fulfilled my promise to the organization and the greater community to retire the role of President, handing the power and responsibility of being the public face of OSI over to the Executive Director.
- Supported expansion of membership and further professionalization across all programmatic activity.

President from May 2020 to September 2021

- Steadied the organization through pandemic-driven staff churn, temporarily taking on staff duties while recruiting and onboarding, first, an interim General Manager, and then an Executive Director.
- Engaged a leadership consultant to lead the board through candid self-reflection, vision and goal setting, ultimately redefining the role of the board and the way it worked with staff.
- Reinvigorated board engagement, ensuring every officer role and committee was staffed and had the beginnings of a succession plan in place.

Vice President from May 2019 to May 2020

- Represented OSI in the media and at critical industry events to protect and promote open source amid efforts, by both reactionaries and VC-backed startups, to coopt the Open Source Definition.
- Supported staff-driven efforts to channel and focus the board's passion through annual exercises including goal setting and performance evaluations.
- Continued recruiting new board candidates to fill gaps and create a robust leadership pipeline.

Chief Financial Officer from April 2017 to May 2019

- Created an organizational development proposal, regrounding a fractious board in the mission and values, while clarifying short and long term staffing needs and driving board reform toward that end.
- Built a budget and financial projections to enable the board to make better decisions about how to allocate resources and drive increased fundraising activity.

- Recruited people from a diversity of backgrounds to run for the OSI board, helping the board to achieve gender parity among its members.

Director from March 2016 to April 2017

- Recruited organizations to strengthen the alliance to protect and promote open source.
- Established productive working relationships with fellow board members and critical industry luminaries.
- Built enthusiasm for OSI's work and increased its individual membership.

Community Manager at O'Reilly Media, Oct. 2013 to Mar. 2016

- Pioneered the Community Manager role for O'Reilly, writing guidelines, developing processes, building tools, and helping to grow the team from one to five.
- Navigated multiple crises that spilled onto social media and into in-person events, each time prioritizing safety, managing the story, and using the experience to mitigate future risk.
- Advised on editorial and marketing strategy, doing research and outreach to recruit readers, authors, attendees, sponsors, and community partners.

Other Roles

- **Co-organizer** of Web & Interactive Media Professionals (WIMP) from 2011 to 2015
- **CEO** at Bluebird Interactive from 2011 to 2013
- **Freelance Web Developer and Digital Marketing Consultant** from 2002 to 2011